

Three Rivers Trade Academy - Shop Welding Safety Guide

Purpose

This guide supports the Industrial Safety Instructor program at Three Rivers Trade Academy. It covers the baseline personal protective equipment and shop conduct expected of every welding student before an arc is ever struck.

Personal Protective Equipment

An auto-darkening welding helmet rated to the correct shade is mandatory. Wear flame-resistant leather gloves, a welding jacket, and steel-toe boots. Cotton or wool clothing only; synthetic fabrics melt and must never enter the welding bay.

Ventilation and Fume Control

Run the bay exhaust on every shift. Galvanized stock must be ground clean before welding to avoid zinc-oxide fume fever. Keep your head out of the plume and let the local exhaust pull fumes away from your breathing zone.

Fire Watch

Keep a charged extinguisher within reach. A thirty-minute fire watch follows any hot work near combustibles. Clear the floor of rags, sawdust, and solvent before striking an arc.

Instructor Sign-Off

No student runs a machine unsupervised until the safety checklist is signed. The instructor of record verifies competency on each process before solo shop time is granted.